

*Phocoenoides dalli*

## Dall's porpoise

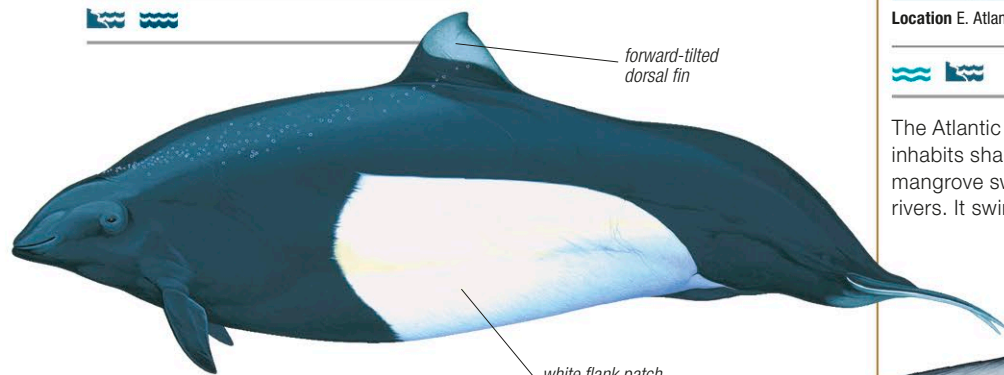


Location North Pacific

Length 5¼–7¾ ft  
(1.6–2.4 m)Weight 130–440 lb  
(60–200 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Least concern



forward-tilted dorsal fin

white flank patch

This large, robust-bodied, rapid-swimming porpoise is mainly black apart from a white patch along each flank and perhaps white tips to the flukes and dorsal fin. The head and

flippers are small compared to the body, and there are 23–28 pairs of teeth in the upper and lower jaws. Small schools of Dall's porpoises sometimes merge to form vast groups numbering thousands. They make a variety of clicking sounds, and feed on fish and squid—from pilchards at the surface to lanternfish at middle depth. They can swim up to about 34 mph (55 kph).

*Sousa teuszii*

## Atlantic humpback dolphin



Location E. Atlantic

Length 7¼–9¼ ft  
(2.4–2.8 m)Weight 620 lb  
(280 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Vulnerable



The Atlantic humpback dolphin inhabits shallow coasts, reefs, mangrove swamps, estuaries, and rivers. It swims slowly and feeds

mainly on schooling fish. It has 26–32 pairs of peglike teeth in the upper and lower jaws. This dolphin forms schools of up to 25 and also associates with humans, following shrimp boats for disturbed fish or herding fish toward shore-based nets in return for a share of the catch. It is very similar to *Sousa plumbea*, which frequents the Indian Ocean, and *Sousa chinensis* in the coastal West Pacific. The Atlantic humpback dolphin, however, is slate gray with pale underparts. Those in the Indian Ocean are larger and darker, perhaps with blue-black flecks. Individuals around China are smallest, almost pink with gray flecks around the head and eyes, and the dorsal fin lacks the inward curve on its trailing edge.



melon forms angle with beak

*Sotalia fluviatilis*

## Tucuxi

Location Central America,  
N.E. South AmericaLength Up to 5 ft  
(1.5 m)Weight Up to 115 lb  
(52 kg)

Social unit Variable

Status Data deficient

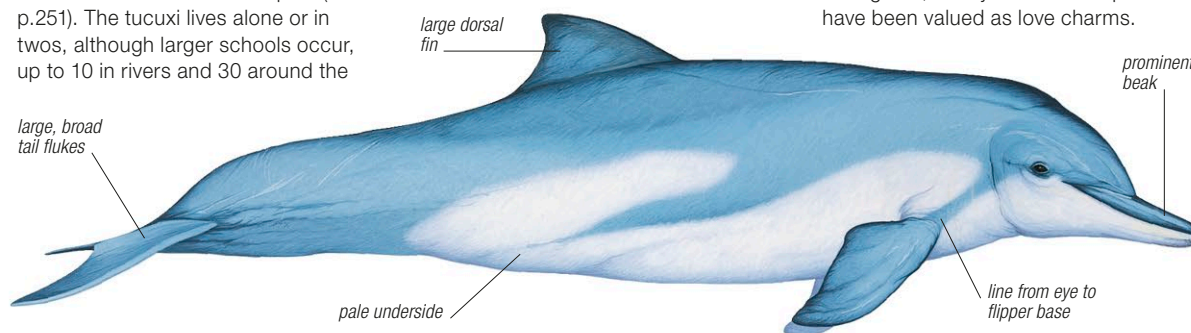


The tucuxi (pronounced “too-koo-shee”) is one of the smallest dolphins, stocky with large flippers, flukes, and dorsal fin. It occurs as a marine form

around the coasts and river estuaries of northeast South America, and as a river form in the lower reaches and lakes of the Amazon system. It is a different species to the solely freshwater Amazon river dolphin (see p.251). The tucuxi lives alone or in twos, although larger schools occur, up to 10 in rivers and 30 around the

coast. It may leap, somersault, and surf waves—but the reason for this is not clear. Prey up to 14 in (35 cm) long is swallowed whole, including fish such as anchovies and catfish, and

squid. In some places, local tradition forbids hunting these dolphins. However, many are accidentally asphyxiated in fishing nets, and some are deliberately killed for meat or fishing bait; the eyes and other parts have been valued as love charms.



large dorsal fin

large, broad tail flukes

pale underside

prominent beak

line from eye to flipper base

*Lagenorhynchus obscurus*

## Dusky dolphin

Location S. Atlantic,  
Indian Ocean, S. PacificLength 5½–7 ft  
(1.7–2.1 m)Weight 155–185 lb  
(70–85 kg)

Social unit Variable

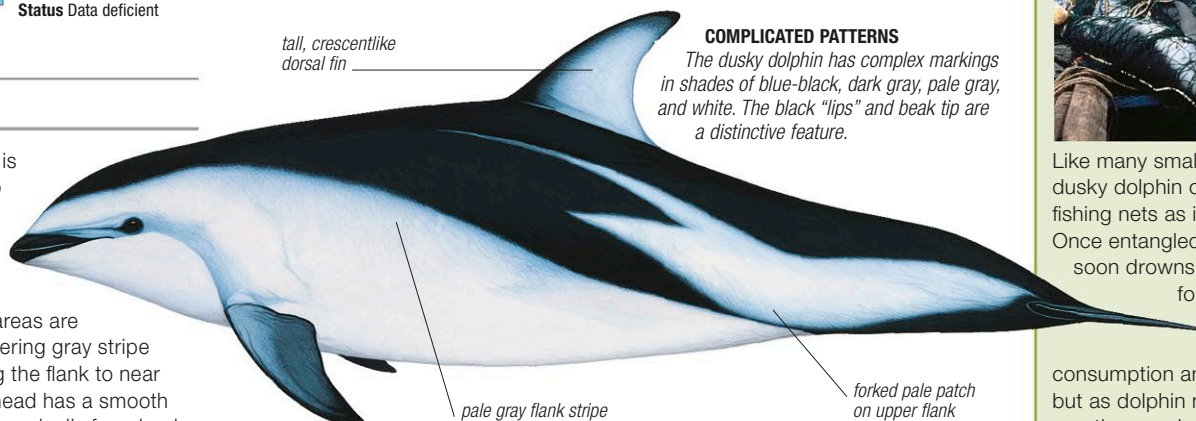
Status Data deficient



The dusky dolphin is mainly dark gray to blue-black on its upperside, and pale gray or white on the underside. These areas are separated by a tapering gray stripe from the face along the flank to near the tail base. The head has a smooth profile that widens gradually from beak to blowhole. The species occurs as 3

subspecies based respectively around South America (*Lagenorhynchus obscurus fitzroyi*), southern Africa (*Lagenorhynchus obscurus obscurus*), and New Zealand (unnamed). It prefers waters of 50–64° F (10–18° C) and less than 655 ft (200 m) deep. Off South America, it feeds by day on schooling

fish, such as anchovies, and squid; off New Zealand, feeding is mainly by night at middle depths. Schools of dusky dolphins change rapidly in size and composition, varying in number from 2 up to 1,000. Groups often engage in much leaping, chasing, and rubbing.



tall, crescentlike dorsal fin

pale gray flank stripe

forked pale patch on upper flank

## COMPLICATED PATTERNS

The dusky dolphin has complex markings in shades of blue-black, dark gray, pale gray, and white. The black “lips” and beak tip are a distinctive feature.

## CONSERVATION



Like many small cetaceans, the dusky dolphin often falls victim to fishing nets as it pursues its prey. Once entangled in their mesh, it soon drowns. This species was formerly hunted off the coast of Peru, for human consumption and for fishing bait, but as dolphin numbers fell, this practice was banned in 1996.